



Translating Life Sciences

Kenya Institute of Primate Research

POLICY DOCUMENT

Research Policy

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FOREWORD



The Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE) is a State Corporation in the Ministry of Health, State Department for Public Health and Professional Standards, established under Legal Notice No. 273 of 2017 in the Science, Technology and Innovation Act No. 28 of 2013 and a Presidential Executive Order No. 1 of January 2023. Its key functions include preclinical, biomedical and translational research and conservation towards improving human health.

This Research Policy sets out how the KIPRE will achieve her legal mandate while fostering innovation, creativity and cutting-edge research. The policy also recognizes the role of partners in supporting her research agenda and provides a framework for engagement. The policy is anchored on the Universal Health Coverage (UHC) pillars, Kenya Vision 2030 Agenda and is in compliance with the Constitution of Kenya, 2010. This policy is tailored to support implementation of the National Government Development Agenda as presented in the Bottom-up Economic Transformation Agenda (BETA) 2023-2027.

As we adopt this policy document, it is my sincere hope that both local and international ethical research standards and guidelines would be met by all KIPRE staff members and partners. Finally, KIPRE Board of Directors and Management will commit itself to the implementation of this policy for its optimum contribution towards the achievement of our Vision and Mission and needs of all our stakeholders.

Signed:

Josephat Mulimba

Date: 28 day of Nov. 2024

Professor Josephat Mulimba, PhD., FRSM

Chairman, Board of Directors

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PREFACE



The Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE) recognizes and understands the significance of high-quality research that follows laid down procedures and regulations. The overarching aim of this research policy is to guide the conduct of scientific research and product development by facilitating and ensuring ethical, quality, and impactful research for the Kenyan people.

The Policy will also ensure that all research activities have a clear purpose drawn from the mission and vision of the Institute and that all resources mobilized for research activities are directed towards the fulfilment of institutional goals. Additionally, the policy will strengthen research capacity and increase the contribution of the Institute to the world of knowledge and health products. Besides, the policy provides a framework on how research will be coordinated and executed in a manner that includes all directorates and divisions.

Finally, the policy emphasizes the need to work with various stakeholders to support KIPRE's mandate. These include: Local communities, County Governments, Government Ministries, Semi-Autonomous Agencies (SAGAS) and International organizations.

Signed:



Date: 28 day of NOV 2024

Dr. Peter Gichuhi Mwethera, PhD, MBS

Director General

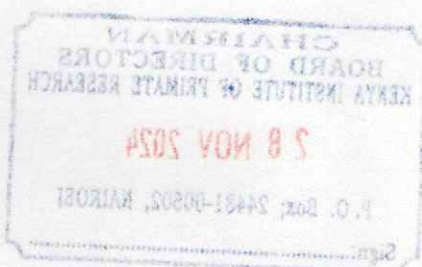


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ABBREVIATIONS

AREC	Animal Research Ethics Committee
DG	Director General
DRPD	Directorate of Research and Product Development
EH&S	Environmental Health and Safety
GoK	Government of Kenya
HREC	Human Research Ethics Committee
IECs	Institutional Ethics Committees
IP	Intellectual Property
ISERC	Institutional and Scientific and Ethical Review Committee
KIPRE	Kenya Institute of Primate Research
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
MoH	Ministry of Health
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MTA	Material Transfer Agreement
PI	Principal Investigator
PPADA	Public Procurement and Asset Disposal Act
SOP	Standard Operating Procedures

DEFINITION OF TERMS

Administrative cost: Expenses incurred that are not directly tied to a specific objective e.g. costs associated with general services; basic costs of taxes, rent, insurance, licensing fees, utilities, accounting and legal teams, administrative staff, facility upkeep, etc.

Animal: Refers to a live, non-human vertebrate, including fertilized eggs, fetuses and embryos, i.e. fish, amphibians, reptiles, birds and mammals, and encompassing domestic animals, feral animals, purpose-bred animals, farm animals, wildlife and higher invertebrates, such as the advanced members from the Cephalopoda and Decapoda (for example, octopus, squid, cuttlefish).

Author: An author is an individual who has made a significant intellectual or scholarly contribution to research and its output, and agrees to be listed as an author.

Biosafety: Defines the ethically responsible handling and containment conditions under which infectious microorganisms and hazardous biological materials can be safely manipulated and disposed of.

Biosafety material: Includes genetically modified organisms, infectious materials, pathogens, ionizing radiation and cytotoxic substances.

Collaboration (also research collaboration or collaborative research): Means research conducted with any partner(s) external to KIPRE including research organizations, industry, government and not-for-profit organizations in Kenya or internationally. Collaborative research can take various forms including, inter disciplinary, multi-disciplinary and trans disciplinary collaboration. This will include contractual research.

Conflict of commitment: Any situation in which an individual Staff Member's or Visitor's primary professional loyalty is not to the Institution because the time devoted to outside activities adversely affects their capacity to meet their responsibilities as set out in their employment contract or appointment, respectively. This refers to a situation in which a staff or an affiliate engages in an outside professional activity paid or unpaid that involves a commitment of time that may interfere or appear to interfere with the fulfilment of the staff's obligations to the organization.

Conflict of interest: Any situation in which real or perceived interests of a staff member, visitor or student may run counter to the interests of the Institution or negatively affect their employment or duties.

Conscientious objection: For the purpose of this policy, means a complaint or objection in relation to the care and use of animals in KIPRE's teaching and/or research activities. A conscientious objection may be registered via this policy (refer to Research Misconduct).

Evaluation: Is the systematic and objective assessment of the design, implementation, and results of an ongoing or completed policy, programme or project to determine the relevance and fulfilment of objectives, developmental efficiency, effectiveness, impact and sustainability.

Health research: Includes but is not limited to research that contributes to knowledge of: biological, clinical, psychological, or social welfare matters including processes as regards humans; the causes and effects of and responses to disease; effects of the environment on humans; methods to improve health care service delivery; new pharmaceuticals, medicines, interventions and devices; new technologies to improve health and health care.

Impact: Means the demonstrable contribution that research makes to the wider community (the economy, environment and society) beyond academic interest or discovery.

Intellectual property (also IP): Is defined in the Intellectual Property Policy as creations of the human mind including patents, utility models, industrial designs, trademarks, geographical indications, layout designs, trade secrets copyrights and plant breeder's rights, genetic resources and their derivatives and progeny.

Material transfer agreement (MTA): Is a contract that governs the transfer of tangible research materials from one organization to another when the recipient intends to use it for their own research purposes. The MTA defines the rights of the provider and the recipient for the materials and any derivatives.

Memorandum of understanding (MOU): Is a non-binding agreement between 2 or more parties that expresses a common intention to act in a certain way. It is often used in cases where the parties either do not want or cannot create a legally enforceable agreement. For example, an MOU might be used to strengthen an existing informal relationship with another party.

Monitoring: A continuous process of collection, analyzing and reporting data on specified indicators on a project's or programme's inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes and impacts, as well as external factors, in order to track actual achievement of objectives and progress in the use of allocated funds.

Research: The investigation undertaken to discover new facts and examining a problem to get additional information. It comprises three activities: basic research, applied research and experimental development.

Researcher: A researcher is someone who conducts an organized and systematic investigation to discover new information or reach a new understanding of a topic of interest.

Research administration: Research administration is the process of planning, organizing, directing, reporting, and facilitating research activities. It also includes managing resources, such as funding, staff development and equipment, to support research activities.

Research contract: Means the written, approved, legally binding arrangement executed in line with this policy between KIPRE and the client. This includes but is not limited to a contract for research services, memorandum of understanding, data sharing agreement, material transfer agreement, an acceptance letter, work order or internal approval that commits the institute to the receipt of funds or to otherwise undertake a research project.

Research data: Means recorded information, obtained during a research process, regardless of form or the media on which it may be recorded. The term includes computer software (computer programs, databases and documentation thereof), and records of scientific or technical nature. The term does not include information incidental to research administration such as financial, administrative, cost or pricing, or management information. In practice scientific data include both intangible data (statistics, findings, conclusions) and tangible data. Tangible data include, but are not limited to notes, printouts, electronic storage, photographs, slides, negatives, films, scans, images, autoradiograms, electro-physical recordings, gels, blots, spectra, cell lines, reagents, modified organisms, specimens, consent forms, case report forms, collected organisms and other materials that are relevant to the research project.

Research data management: Research data management describes the process of organizing, storage, accessing and protection of data generated from research.

Research ethics: This refers to the principles and standards of conduct that guide researchers in their work.

Research equipment: Research equipment refers to the physical instruments or apparatus used primarily for research purposes. This includes vehicles, laboratory apparatus, the laboratory, computers, phones, laptops, printers and animal cages.

Research integrity: Means a form of academic integrity that requires researchers to ensure their findings are based on sound research methodology, honesty and accuracy. Research integrity ensures that the results of research are rigorous, defensible and reproducible.

Research misconduct: Research misconduct means fabrication, falsification, or plagiarism in proposing, performing, or reviewing research, or in reporting research results.

Research outcome: Is a change resulting from the application or use of the results of research.

Research output: Research output is any data, discovery, insight, policy paper, journal articles, reports, prototypes arising from research projects or programmes.

Research participants: The individuals who take part in a study, either directly or indirectly via a representative, and who have given their informed consent. Research participants can be identified directly or indirectly, via an identifier such as a name, an ID number, location data, or via factors specific to the person's physical, physiological, genetic, mental, economic, cultural or social identity.

Research project: Means any research-related activity that has investigation as a primary objective, has a defined plan, methodology, resources, timeline and deliverables and has the potential to contribute new knowledge, both theoretical and practical.

Research project leader: Also called Principal Investigator or PI means the named KIPRE staff member with overall responsibility for the research project including the proposal, project management, research conduct, reporting and delivery of outcomes and for the listing order of research project members.

Research proposal (or proposal): Means an outline of a proposed research project or activity. Proposals are normally required for funding applications for competitive grants (including those that are led by another institution), tenders, contract research proposals, expressions of interest, intellectual property commercialization and fellowships.

Research records: Means any documentation or information prepared, maintained or stored as evidence by the institute or individuals for use in their work, and includes correspondence (hardcopy and electronic), grant application documentation, human or animal ethics protocols (applications, approvals and related documents), signed participant consent forms and information sheets for research participants, research data management plans, authorship agreements, technical reports, research reports (to project or funding board) and other items like these.

Research quality: This refers to the accuracy, reproducibility, and reliability of the process.

Research subjects: Means a human, plant or animal about whom/which a researcher obtains information or biospecimens through intervention or interaction with the subject, and uses, studies, or analyzes the information or biospecimens.

Visiting researcher: Visiting researchers and any other individuals participating in research, teaching, training, or making significant use of KIPRE's facilities, funds, or other resources.

ARTICLE 1: INTRODUCTION

The Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE) is a semi-autonomous government agency (SAGA) established under the Legal Notice No. 273 of 2017 in the Science, Technology and Innovation Act No. 28 of 2013. KIPRE, operates under the Ministry of Health (MoH), State Department for Public Health and Professional Standards through the Presidential Executive order No. 1 of January, 2023.

KIPRE's mandate is on pre-clinical biomedical research and conservation with a focus on Infectious Diseases and One-Health; Reproductive Health and Biology; Non-communicable Diseases; Snakebite Research and Intervention and Evolutionary Ecology, Conservation and Ecosystem Health. Additionally, KIPRE has an established Animal Sciences Directorate that oversees the ethical use of non-human primates and other experimental animals used in pre-clinical research towards development of vaccines, drugs, medical interventions and health technologies.

KIPRE is, therefore, placed as a lead SAGA within MoH with an aim of supporting the government agenda of Universal Health Coverage. To this end, KIPRE has instituted reforms that are geared towards improving efficiency, service and effectiveness of research towards better human health.

1.1 Vision

To be a global centre of excellence in innovative basic and preclinical biomedical research and non-human primate conservation.

1.2 Mission

To improve human health and biodiversity through advances in basic and preclinical biomedical research and non-human primate conservation.

1.3 Core Values

Our core values define the ideals that KIPRE shall maintain to guide decision making within the internal parties and in the interactions with our various stakeholders. The following are the core

values to ensure quality research at KIPRE: research integrity, professionalism, good corporate governance, equity and customer focus.

1.4 Guiding Principles

The following are the guiding principles to ensure quality research at KIPRE: efficiency, teamwork, partnership, innovativeness and dynamism.

1.5 Functions

The functions of KIPRE are as follows:

- a) Conduct basic, pre-clinical and translational research using non-human primates and other experimental animals in liaison with the relevant government agencies;
- b) Establish an incubation centre linking research and industry in the health products value chain;
- c) Contribute to early warning systems for emerging and re-emerging diseases;
- d) Establish and operate a national breeding colony of non-human primates and other experimental laboratory animals for research purposes;
- e) Provide national in-vitro fertilization services for endangered wildlife of Kenya in liaison with relevant Government agencies;
- f) Undertake studies in non-human primate conservation biology and primatology;
- g) Create and maintain a national non-human primate database on census, research affiliations, and geo-spatial distribution of non-human and related zoonotic diseases;
- h) Serve as a national research centre for venom and anti-venom including snake bite disease;
- i) Undertake basic and pre-clinical research on reproductive health, infectious and non-communicable diseases using non-human primates;
- j) Develop and characterize both non-human primate and other experimental animal models for priority diseases in Kenya;
- k) Undertake research in Human African Trypanosomiasis disease;
- l) Undertake capacity building in animal welfare, ethical use and care of non-human primates and other experimental animals in laboratory settings; and
- m) Perform any other function which is incidental to the performance of any of the foregoing functions.

ARTICLE 2: POLICY STATEMENT, RATIONALE, SCOPE AND OBJECTIVES

2.1 Policy Statement

KIPRE commits to ensure ethical, quality and impactful research guided by the Institution's core values and mandate.

2.2 Rationale of the Policy

KIPRE requires a nurturing environment for continuous improvement in research practices, compliance to ethical standards, promotion of partnerships and optimization of resource utilization. This requires a well-coordinated framework to align the research activities and associated resources. This policy seeks to address the research gaps and support the mandate of KIPRE.

2.3 Scope of the Policy

- 2.3.1 The Policy applies to all KIPRE research activities, researchers, collaborators and affiliates. It contains rules, principles and regulations that KIPRE researchers and her collaborators shall observe while conducting research in order to maintain the integrity and dignity of the Institute and meet National and International standards.
- 2.3.2 The policy is supported by standard operating procedures and guidelines to help researchers initiate, plan, conduct, complete their research and share the outputs with the scientific community and general public.

2.4 Objectives of the Policy

The objectives of the policy are as follows:

- i) To provide a framework for the management of research at KIPRE
- ii) To promote quality and relevance of KIPRE's research activities
- iii) To enhance the capacity of KIPRE to undertake research
- iv) To facilitate research collaborations and partnerships
- v) To enhance transparency and accountability in conducting research

ARTICLE 3: RESEARCH PRIORITY AREAS

- 3.1 Implementation of KIPRE's strategic goals and objectives are built on the foundations of Constitution of Kenya 2010, Vision 2030, KIPRE Legal Notice 237 of 2017, KIPRE Charter (2024) and KIPRE Strategic Plan (2023-2027).
- 3.2 The Research Thematic Areas are identified as follows:
- i) Infectious Diseases
 - ii) One Health
 - iii) Reproductive Health and Biology
 - iv) Non-communicable Diseases
 - v) Snakebite Research and Interventions
 - vi) Ecology, Conservation, Ecosystem Health and Climate Change
 - vii) Animal health, behaviour and breeding
 - viii) Drug discovery, testing and toxicology
 - ix) Diagnostics and pathology
 - x) Traditional medicine and phytochemistry
 - xi) Climate and Health
 - xii) Antimicrobial resistance
 - xiii) Phage Biology
 - xiv) Stem cell research
 - xv) Organ transplant
 - xvi) Microbicides
 - xvii) Medical Interventions
- 3.3 In consultation with the Research Committee and other stakeholders, the Directorate of Research and Product Development shall, from time to time, review research thematic areas, based on current and emerging issues.
- 3.4 Based on the identified research thematic areas, the Institute shall review its research strategy in order to realign with national and global health agendas, and emerging needs and priorities.

ARTICLE 4: RESEARCH ADMINISTRATION

4.1 Introduction

Research at KIPRE will be led by the Directorate of Research and Product Development and working closely with KIPRE's Research Committee, the Institutional Scientific and Ethics Review Committee, Directorate of Animal Science, Welfare and Ethics, and the Directorate of Capacity Building, Partnerships and Grants Management.

4.1.1 KIPRE Research Committee

4.1.1.1 The Director General shall appoint a Research Committee of KIPRE composed of seven (7) members, constituted from scientists from KIPRE's Directorates and Divisions, as outlined below. The Chair of the Research Committee shall be appointed by the Director General from the membership outlined and the Secretary shall be the Director Research and Product Development. The research committee membership shall comprise of:

- i) Director Research and Product Development shall be the secretary of KIPRE's Research Committee
- ii) Director or representative from the Directorate of Animal Science, Welfare and Ethics
- iii) Director or representative from Directorate of Capacity Building, Partnerships and Grants Management.
- iv) Deputy Director or representative from Finance and Accounts Division
- v) Two (2) Senior Research Scientist from any of the Divisions under the Directorate of Research and Product Development
- vi) Deputy Director or representative from Partnerships and Grants Management

4.1.1.2 The Research Committee shall meet at least once quarterly and/or as need arise.

4.1.1.3 The responsibilities of the committee shall include but not be limited to:

- i) Advise the Directorate of Research and Product development and the Director General on development and implementation of KIPRE's research programs and policies.
- ii) Overseeing a KIPRE reward scheme for excellence in research and innovation.

- iii) Receiving regular reports from, and advising, the Directorate of Research and Product development and the institutional ethical review committees on the development of guidelines and research policies and procedures.
- iv) Receiving and reviewing proposals for internally funded research grants.
- v) Recommending allocation of internal research funds to successful applicants.
- vi) Identifying and recommending establishment of research infrastructure to the Director General.
- vii) Organising scientific workshops, symposiums, seminars, webinars and the KIPRE scientific conference.
- viii) Review and prioritise institutional research grants applications.

4.1.2 Directorate of Research and Product Development (DRPD)

- 4.1.2.1 The Directorate of Research and Product Development (DRPD) will be responsible for overall coordination of research programmes and initiatives in the Institution.
- 4.1.2.2 DRPD shall ensure that research is effectively managed including but not limited to:
 - i) Coordinating and overseeing all KIPRE research activities.
 - ii) Pre and post approval monitoring and evaluation of research projects working closely with Institutional Scientific and Ethics Committee and the Directorate of Animal Science, Welfare and Ethics.
 - iii) Developing and implementing policies and procedures to ensure that research is conducted in an ethical, efficient, and effective manner.
 - iv) Establishing and maintaining an inventory of all research projects and outputs.
 - v) Staff development to enhance research and research administration.
 - vi) Support and work with the Directorate of Capacity Building, Partnership and Grants Management on the acquisition and administration of research projects grants, cooperative agreements, contracts, and other agreements including government agencies, universities, private sponsors and foundations.
 - vii) Support and work closely with the Research Committee to review and prioritise institutional research grants applications.

4.1.3 Scientific and Ethical approval process

- 4.1.3.1 The Institution shall establish and operationalise KIPRE's Human Research Ethics Committee and Animal Research Ethics Committee to enhance the quality of research and protect the rights of research subjects (human, animals and plants). The two committees shall endeavour, in the spirit of continual scientific and ethical compliance, improve and streamline the research approval process for all researchers including staff, research affiliates and students by creating requisite institutional review committees/boards.
- 4.1.3.2 All internal project proposals funded locally or internationally (including collaborative projects) must be reviewed by KIPRE's scientific and ethical approval committees or any other NACOSTI approved committees/boards. KIPRE's Institutional Scientific and Ethics Committees may also evaluate non-KIPRE affiliated research or be the lead to review a multi-centered research project.
- 4.1.3.3 The two Institutional Scientific and Ethics Review Committees, covering both human and animal subjects, are outlined below:
- i) **Animal Research Ethics Committee (AREC):** KIPRE's AREC will review the scientific merit, ethics and animal welfare components of research proposals and oversee the set experimental protocols, prior to the implementation of the research project(s). It will also perform a comprehensive harm-benefit analysis of animal experimentation in proposals being reviewed. The composition of this committee shall be guided by the National and International guidelines.
 - ii) **Human Research Ethics Committee (HREC):** KIPRE HREC will review and approve any health-related research that involves direct interactions with or observation of human subjects, the use of potentially identifiable personal health records, data, tissue samples, and/or human progenitor or stem cells. All clinical trials must also be approved by the Pharmacy and Poisons Board (MoH, 2016). The KIPRE HREC will function according to a set of guidelines, policies and procedures as outlined in the HREC standard operating procedures and as per the Science, Technology and Innovation Act, 2013. Including: Deciding independently whether the proposed research protects the interests of participants (humans) adequately and keeps to exemplary standards in research activities, as per the KIPRE's guidelines on the responsible conduct of research;

Engaging in continuous training of researchers in order to ensure their compliance with changing guidelines and protocols, or in cases where certain concerns are indicated; and monitoring progress of research for which approval is granted, starting from time of approval to the termination of research.

4.1.4 KIPRE Research funds

4.1.4.1 KIPRE Internal Research Funds

KIPRE shall establish an Internal Research Fund (IRF) to support various research activities. The Internal Research Fund shall be managed by the Research Committee. The Research Committee shall make a call for submission of research proposals by staff from time to time subject to availability of funds. All submitted proposals shall conform to the standard proposal preparation guidelines as developed by the Research Committee. Proposals will be evaluated competitively by the Research Committee and awarded. The outcome of the award process shall be communicated by the secretary of the Research Committee.

4.1.4.2 Collaborative (External) Research Funds

KIPRE through collaborative research raises funds from other local and international agencies. These funds support research activities, infrastructure, capacity building and innovation. These funds shall be subject to an institutional administrative overhead charge/Indirect costs of 12.5%.

4.1.5 Research contracts

4.1.5.1 All research contracts shall be approved by KIPRE's Director General.

4.1.5.2 The Principal Investigator/research project leader must ensure that all researchers involved in a research project are aware of their responsibilities and obligations under the research contract.

4.1.5.3 Agreements and commitments in relation to intellectual property (IP), including its commercialization (refer to KIPRE's Intellectual Property Policy), provision of rights, transfer of ownership or transfer of institutional material relating to KIPRE IP, must be outlined in the research contract and approved by the Director General or authorized KIPRE delegate.

4.2 Appointment and Responsibilities of Project Staff

Persons employed by the project shall be engaged only for the lifetime of the project.

Such staff shall maintain confidentiality of all project data, findings and patentable innovations and shall not share the project information with non-project staff unless authorized in writing by the Principal Investigator in consultation with the KIRPE Director General.

4.3 Appointment and Responsibilities of Research Associates

4.3.1 Research associates are researchers (including postgraduate students) from other research and academic institutions who seek to interact with researchers and use the location and facilities of KIPRE to further their research work. Research associates are of value to the Institute because they:

- i) Raise the profile of KIPRE with their home institutions.
- ii) Foster research networking, collaborative research and joint publication.
- iii) Impart knowledge and ideas to KIPRE staff and students.
- iv) Inject new research ideas into the KIPRE community of researchers.

4.3.2 Research associates will be appointed by the Director General, KIPRE on fulfilment of the following criteria;

- i) Minimum of a Master's degree in a relevant area of specialization.
- ii) Recommendation from a collaborating KIPRE research scientist.

4.3.3 Research associates must:

- i) Comply with all Government of Kenya regulations concerning the conduct of research in Kenya.
- ii) Comply with the KIPRE Research policy and guidelines.
- iii) Give due acknowledgement of any assistance received from the KIPRE in any publications based on research conducted during the period of association.

4.4 Responsibilities of the Principal Investigator

- 4.4.1 In this Policy, a Principal Investigator (PI) is the person responsible for providing leadership in development and implementation of a research project. The PI is accountable to KIPRE and the donor through the Directorate of Research and Product Development
- 4.4.2 Principal investigators shall be responsible for ensuring:
- i) Smooth implementation of the project as stipulated in the project work plan.
 - ii) Adherence by the project research team to all the provisions of the Research Policy.
 - iii) Adherence to Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) requirements and timely submission of project reports.
 - iv) Proper acquisition, use and retention of all project research data.
 - v) Compliance with the project's technical and financial agreement.
 - vi) Acquisition of materials and safe disposal as guided by the Material Safety Data Sheets.

ARTICLE 5: INCENTIVES

- 5.1 Maintaining morale is very important to ensure that staff involved in research and related activities are driven to work hard for the Institution. Organizations have adopted incentive schemes to enhance success of their organizations. These schemes may include certificates of recognition, promotion, allowances, awards for researchers and research teams. The benefits include an increase in productivity, decreased staff turnover and help attract new talent.
- 5.2 KIPRE shall provide research incentives as guided below:
- i) KIPRE shall develop and implement an incentive scheme for researchers and research teams.
 - ii) KIPRE shall establish guidelines on the criteria for awarding outstanding researchers and research teams from the incentive scheme.
 - iii) Payment of research allowance shall be according to the approved effort compensation scheme and/or as provided in the proposal research budgets.

ARTICLE 6: HEALTH, SAFETY AND ENVIRONMENT COMMITTEE

- 6.1 KIPRE is committed to provide a clean and safe environment for staff, partners and the community. KIPRE will establish a committee on Health, Safety and Environment. The committee will deal with specific requirements related to chemical hygiene, radiological hazards, lasers, and biohazardous agents and emergency procedures. Additionally the Committee shall establish standard operating procedures (SOPs) for dealing with hazardous substances and waste as well as determine risks and their mitigations.
- 6.2 The constitution of the committee shall be guided by Occupational Health and Safety Act (2007) and any other relevant laws and regulations. Members to the committee shall be appointed by the Director General.

ARTICLE 7: COLLABORATIVE RESEARCH

KIPRE is committed to support multi-disciplinary, multi-institutional and multi-country research collaborations and partnerships for mutual benefits. All collaborations shall be guided by as follows:

- i) KIPRE will undertake collaboration, which is in line with its core values and mandate.
- ii) KIPRE will be guided by formal written agreements approved by the Director General.
- iii) Collaborative arrangements shall be monitored and formally reviewed periodically.
- iv) Participants in collaborative activities must comply with institutional policy, national and International legislations and regulations including approvals (permits, licences, and applicable ethical approvals).
- v) Address issues related to ownership and management of intellectual property with reference to KIPRE's Intellectual Property Policy.

ARTICLE 8: RESEARCH DATA MANAGEMENT

- 8.1 KIPRE is committed to manage research and personal data in compliance with ethical principles for fair data sharing, data rights as well as intellectual property considerations. Researchers are expected to adhere to FAIR data principles to optimize the reuse of data. This entails that research data should be *Findable, Accessible, Interoperable* and

Reusable to optimize sharing (See Wilkinson et al. (2016). Research and personal data will be managed according to the provisions of the Data Protection Act of 2019, the two KIPRE Institutional Scientific and Ethics Committees and other relevant National and International laws and regulations.

8.2 Data shall be subject to the following:

- i) All data arising from research and related activities conducted by or on behalf of KIPRE belongs to KIPRE.
- ii) The management of data arising from collaborative research shall be subject to prior written agreements.
- iii) KIPRE shall establish and maintain a centralised integrated research data management system for KIPRE collections and research data/materials.
- iv) Researchers are responsible for managing and archiving their research data in KIPRE's centralised integrated research data management system.
- v) Researchers are responsible for submitting their publications to the institutional information repository in the information resource centre.
- vi) Disclosure of Intellectual Property related data shall be guided by KIPRE's Intellectual Property policy.
- vii) Access and sharing of research data shall be subject KIPRE's Data Management and Protection Policy and approval by the Director General.

ARTICLE 9: DISSEMINATION OF RESEARCH OUTPUTS

9.1 KIPRE is committed to nurturing a strong culture in the generation, sharing and application of information and knowledge emanating from its research and related activities.

9.2 Research outputs shall be subject to the following:

- i) Dissemination of information and knowledge emanating from research and related activities shall be subject to approval by the Director General.
- ii) All research outputs emanating from research activities undertaken under or on behalf of KIPRE, shall acknowledge the Institution.

ARTICLE 10: AUTHORSHIP

Researchers have the responsibility to publish their research findings accurately in legitimate scholarly journals. The following principles apply to authorship:

- i) Authorship should be discussed and agreed upon during the planning phase of research, and expectations of authors clearly outlined.
- ii) Authorship credit should be based on substantial contributions to conception and design, or acquisition of data, or analysis and interpretation of data; drafting the article or revising it critically for important intellectual content; and final approval of the version to be published.

ARTICLE 11: INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

In undertaking research activity, there is potential of generating new ideas and inventions that may lead to new products and services. These can be protected in the form of Intellectual Property (IP) rights. The management and ownership of Intellectual Property (IP) arising from research activities conducted under or on behalf of the Institution shall be subjected to KIPRE's IP Policy.

ARTICLE 12: RESEARCH MISCONDUCT

12.1 KIPRE is committed to ensuring professionalism and ethical conduct of research and related activities eg

12.2 Any grievances arising from collaborative research involving a non-KIPRE staff shall be handled as stipulated in the research contract agreement.

- i) Researchers are expected to manage complaints in line with the following:
- ii) Concerns or complaints around workplace behaviour or researcher conduct shall be resolved in line with the relevant institutional policies and guidelines.

12.3 All allegations on research misconduct shall:

- i) In the first instance be referred to the Director, Research and Product Development, for handling within 30 days.
- ii) Should the matter not have been resolved within 30 days, it shall be referred to the Director General.

ARTICLE 13: CONFLICT OF INTEREST AND COMMITMENT

13.1 Conflict of interest and/or commitment in research exists when the individual has interests in the outcome or process of the research that may lead to a personal advantage and that might compromise the integrity of the research. It is essential to identify and address conflicts of interest and/or to ensure unbiased decision making and integrity.

13.2 KIPRE shall:

- i) Ensure all participants in research and related activities for or on behalf of KIPRE declare conflict of interest and/or commitment in a prescribed format.
- ii) Provide a mechanism for resolution of conflict of interest and/or commitment to be guided by the Director General.

ARTICLE 14: DISPUTE RESOLUTION

KIPRE is committed to establish effective and efficient mechanisms for dispute resolution in research and related activities. Any dispute arising under the implementation of the policy:

- i) Shall first be reported to the Director of Research and Product Development for handling the dispute within 30 days.
- ii) If unresolved within 30 days it shall be referred to the Director General.

ARTICLE 15: PROJECT COMPLETION

The following shall be applied at the end of a project:

- i) Research project leaders are responsible for ensuring the full completion of a research project.
- ii) At the end of a research project, the PI shall submit two copies of the final report and any other publication(s) to the Director of Research and Product Development.
- iii) All research papers published as a result of KIPRE or externally funded projects managed by KIPRE shall acknowledge KIPRE.
- iv) All publications shall be uploaded in the KIPRE Institutional repository in line with the Institutional Repository.
- v) The PIs and their collaborators shall disseminate research findings through policy briefs, publications, stakeholder workshops, seminars and conferences. The

Principal Investigators are encouraged to include a dissemination/publication cost in project budget.

ARTICLE 16: TERMINATION OF A RESEARCH PROJECT

A collaborative research project shall be terminated through consultation between the Institute, the donor and PI under the following circumstances:

- i) If the project is incapable of meeting its objectives and/or is being implemented unsatisfactorily.
- ii) If the project violates the principles and requirements in this Policy and other applicable national laws and regulations, and with the approval of Director General.
- iii) If the funds allocated are insufficient to complete the project, funds are not released on time, budgetary changes or if the prevailing economic situation renders the budget unimplementable.
- iv) Act of God (Force majeure); In case of retirement or death of the PI the KIPRE will appoint a new PI in consultation with the donor and project collaborators where applicable.

ARTICLE 17: RESEARCH EQUIPMENT AND FACILITIES

17.1 In the course of research various equipment can be obtained through purchase, donation, loan/placement and hiring.

17.2 The following clauses shall guide research equipment:

- i) All research equipment procured by KIPRE shall belong to the Institution.
- ii) All research equipment donated to KIPRE shall belong to the institution.
- iii) Ownership of loaned/hired/placed equipment shall be guided by prior agreement approved by the Director General.
- iv) All research vehicles shall be registered under KIPRE or as specified in the contract for multi-institutional projects.
- v) Any laboratories or centres established through research funds shall be the property of KIPRE and shall be used by all staff except where accessibility is restricted to authorized staff only.

- vi) Laboratories or centres established through research funds shall be headed by the Principal Investigator or a person appointed by the Director General.
- vii) Disposal of research equipment shall be guided by the Public Procurement and Asset Disposal Act (PPADA Revised, 2022), KIPRE's Procurement Manual, other relevant national legislations and any prior negotiated agreements.

ARTICLE 18: MONITORING AND EVALUATION

An effective monitoring and evaluation mechanism will help ensure cost effectiveness, timeliness, and quality in achieving the objectives of the policy.

Monitoring and evaluation shall involve the following:

- i) The planning function/department is responsible for M&E of all research and related activities at KIPRE or carried out on behalf of KIPRE.
- ii) All research projects shall include a M&E component and budget in their proposals.
- iii) KIPRE shall ensure that M&E is carried out for all approved projects on or behalf of KIPRE including visits to project sites.
- iv) Researchers shall submit reports quarterly reports or as may be required.
- v) KIPRE shall develop a monitoring and evaluation framework for research projects to ensure successful implementation and prudent use of resources.
- vi) The policy will be subjected to periodic monitoring and evaluation of performance on the various deliverables as per the institutional monitoring and evaluation mechanisms.

ARTICLE 19: COMPLIANCE WITH LAWS AND REGULATIONS

19.1 Compliance is a critical aspect of organizational practices, encompassing adherence to policy, regulatory, and ethical standards. It includes adherence to institutional policies governing legislation and standard operating procedures. Compliance promotes professionalism, transparency, accountability, and fairness. This enhances quality service delivery, safeguards institution against legal risks and fosters stakeholder confidence.

19.2 KIPRE shall ensure that:

- i) All participants undertaking research and related activities comply with all applicable laws and regulations.

- ii) This policy shall be interpreted in accordance with the Laws of Kenya and in a manner consistent with other relevant policies.

ARTICLE 20: REVIEW AND AMENDMENT

KIPRE shall review this policy after every three (3) years or any time there are significant changes in the legal and operating environment.

ARTICLE 20: ADOPTION AND IMPLEMENTATION

This Policy shall:

- i) Become effective upon adoption and approval by the Board of Directors
- ii) KIPRE shall develop an implementation plan for the successful operationalisation of this policy.

ARTICLE 22: CITATION

This Policy shall be cited as the KIPRE Research Policy No. POL/KIPRE/DRPD/001

REFERENCES

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<https://www.nature.com/articles/sdata201618>
2. Industrial Property Act 2001 and Copyright Act 2001.
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4. Data Protection Act (No.24 of 2019).
5. Protection of Traditional Knowledge and Cultural Expressions Act (No. 33 of 2016).
6. Science, Technology, and Innovation Act (No. 28 Of 2013).
7. The World Medical Association (1964). The declaration of Helsinki. Ethical principles for medical research involving human subjects (Last amended 2013). Available at:
<https://www.wma.net/policies-post/wma-declaration-of-helsinki-ethical-principles-for-medical-research-involving-human-subjects/> (Accessed 4th May 2024).

8. The World Medical Association (2016). What we do. declaration of Taipei: research on health databases, big data and biobanks. Available at: <https://www.wma.net/what-we-do/medical-ethics/declaration-of-taipei/> (Accessed 4th May 2024).
9. MoH. (2016). Guidelines for Conduct of Clinical Trials in Kenya. PPB, Kenya

ANNEX I: KIPRE RELATED POLICIES AND GUIDELINES

1. Intellectual property policy
2. Consultancy policy
3. Grant or sub-award policy
4. Data management and protection policy
5. Indigenous knowledge policy
6. 2023-2027 Strategic plan
7. Procurement manual
8. Training policy
9. ICT policy
10. Quality policy statement
11. Integrity and anti-corruption policy
12. Effort compensation policy
13. Indigenous knowledge policy
14. Institutional Scientific Ethics Review Committee (ISERC) Standard Operating Procedures
15. The South African Medical Research Council guidelines on the responsible conduct of research